Manly Man

By Brian Hathaway

INTRODUCTION

A Manly Man carries himself with pride and self-assurance. He is not a follower and may not be a leader but, is unswayed by external forces. He goes where he wants, wears what he wants and says what he wants with no fear of condemnation. Brian Hathaway is the quintessential Manly Man – unafraid to speak his thoughts and to explain himself in a world that is often unexplainable. In No Worries . . . I'm Going To, Hathaway outlines a typical day in the life of a manly man . . . with commentary!

No Worries . . . I'm Going To

Wait Wait Wait Wait a minute

Hold up

STOP

. . . .The press

I woke up today without that 5 million pound boulder of stress on my chest and now I feel blessed and can rest.

Oh! to rest these weary extremities that have been inflicted with infirmities unseen or experienced by them before

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So tell me, what does the future have in store?

I don't know

I'm just going to let today be today, I'm going to wake up this morning with a smile on my face, look in the mirror brush my teeth and not wrack my brain wondering whether she's going to call me or not because when a girl says, "let's just be friends," what she really means is "I'm never going to talk to you again."

Accept it

Move on

I just did

And after that I'm going to put on my play clothes, go in the front yard and climb that pecan tree like I did last week, but this time I'm not going to get halfway up it and start debating whether morality is . . .

A social adaptation

A product of Evolution

Or put there, by God

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I'm just going to climb the thing and have fun like I did when I was a kid

And after that I'm going to go to vertebrate zoology class and listen to my boring, lifeless instructor talk about how there are 50 different species of minnow in Arkansas alone.

But I'll smile
Nod
SHOW INTEREST
Act interested

(because that really is interesting if you think about it . . .
Think about it)

And then after that I'll go home and have lunch. The same ol' boring lunch again! Two more fricken' frozen Monterey jack bean and cheese burritos with a glass of distilled water and an orange. But I'll give thanks that I do have food to eat because so many people don't

And after that I'll go to work and paint But I'm not going to paint that boring eggshell white on that old lady's wall like she requested . . . no, I'm not going to do it. I'm going to

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pretend I'm a juvenile Leonardo daVinci and paint a stick figure masterpiece of a young couple frolicking in a field of flowers with little butterflies and gophers popping up here and there. (I'm sure the old lady will appreciate it later in life)

And after that, I'm going to have dinner with my Paw Paw and when he cries to me about how his arthritis is bad -- his own daughter rejects him -- he's sad, I'll put my arm around him and listen -- watch his old weary eyes glisten as he experiences my love for him.

And after that I'll go home, sit on the floor and start singing songs to the one that gave me this joy that I'm feeling, but it's more than just some fleeting feeling, it's eternal truth in which I am reeling.

And then at night I lay my head to rest without the slightest bit of fright or fret knowing I made the day the best I could

And that God truly is good

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TRANSITION

So you see . . . A Manly Man has nothing to do with how much you can bench press, or what kind of truck you drive or how many women you have added to your "repertoire" -- Nope being a Manly Man has nothing to do with your military wardrobe or 1/8 " crew cut or the anchor tattoo on your bicep. Brian Hathaway further defines a "Manly Man" in his poem by the same name.

Manly Man

I don't want my long hair

pretty green eyes with

no I do not have on mascara

Eyelashes

Skinny figure

Undersized T-shirt

Hips

Shake

Too

Much

when I walk

Confuse anybody . . .

I am a Manly Man!

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Within this sissy frame

obviously rib laden chest

lies a heart

that beats

to the drum of a

Native American ritual dancing

wildness

It pumps an ever-cascading supply of untamedness

that a herd of wild mustangs have yet to grasp.

If danger lurks about, I will seek it out.

If adventure abounds, there I will be found.

If a damsel be in distress

I will show her who is best.

I am a Manly Man!

Because I don't flush

and I leave the lid up.

Girls don't break up with me

I break up with them first!

I don't shave the hair on my face

(because I still can't grow facial hair yet, but when I can I

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won't.)

Because beards are tough.

I fart

burp

spit

when I want

Not caring who's nearby

Disrespect my momma

and I will punch you in the eye!

I am a Manly Man!

Or am I?

I tell my guy friends that I love them.

And sometimes, sometimes, I even hug them.

No because I'm not gay. But because I love em'.

And when people talk

I try to listen

a spirit of compassion

That's my vision.

Surely I am a Manly Man

I want to be loved

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and have love

and give Love.

Although I am looking for that beauty

Not helpless

But wants to be rescued.

The Damsel in distress

Man

Woman

Myth

True.

I will fight for her.

Climb the highest tower for her

Love her.

Share with her.

Delight in her.

Be her warrior.

Her protector.

She will be my crown

and I will be hers.

My Masculinity will be passed down

and affirmed to my sons.

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Each of my daughters will know they are lovely

and deserving of authentic romance.

Society tells me all day long

That I have defined manhood completely wrong.

But you ask any honest man and he will agree

You ask any honest woman and she too will see

That I am a Manly Man!

SOURCE INFORMATION

For Both Poems

Author: Brian Hathaway
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AWARD HISTORY

2010 National Qualifier
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